

ANI



Sabha Chairman (depending on who receives it first) forms a three-member committee, including a Supreme Court judge, a chief justice of a high court and a jurist, to probe the charges. If it's received in both Houses on the same day, both heads together constitute the committee

So, by referring to the motion on the same day it was received in Lok Sabha, Dhankhar sought his role in forming the committee

After investigation, the committee submits its report to the Speaker or Chairman. If the judge is found guilty, the motion is taken up for debate and voting in both Houses

To pass, the motion must be approved by each House of Parliament with two majorities: more than half of the total members, and at least two-thirds of the members present and voting

Once passed by both Houses, the motion is sent to the President, who issues an order for removal

Opposition leader in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge to deliver an extended critique of the government's handling of the military operation without interruption.

The timing may have been the trigger, but the tension had been building. For months, the vice-president's relationship with the government had deteriorated. He had started walking a line too close to independence, and too far from deference. Dhankhar's increasingly strident attacks on the judiciary had begun creating complications for a government attempting to manage its own complex relationship with India's courts less overtly. His description of the Supreme Court's use of Article 142 as a "nuclear missile against democratic forces" and his persistent criticism of the collegium system were seen as overreach that potentially jeopardised the government's broader judicial strategy. Some analysts suggest the Narendra Modi-led government may have calculated that sacrificing Dhankhar could help repair relations with a judiciary already sceptical of executive encroachment. In this reading, Dhankhar became expendable collateral in a larger institutional negotiation.

The frostiness of the aftermath speaks volumes about the acrimonious nature of this political divorce. Prime Minister Modi's response came only after 15 hours, a terse tweet wishing Dhankhar "good health", conspicuously lacking the effusive praise typically lavished on departing dignitaries. The man Modi once hailed as "*kisanputra*" (son of farmers) and "inspiring" received a send-off more suited to a dismissed employee than a constitutional head. Even more telling is the lack of any farewell ceremony. Reports that he began packing immediately after submitting his resignation on July 21 night, before it was even formally accepted, suggest he harboured no illusions about possible rehabilitation.

Modi's lone tweet came 15 hours later—terse, impersonal. Even more telling is the absence of any farewell ceremony

THE IMPLICATIONS

Dhankhar's resignation carries implications that extend far beyond the personal. It represents the first instance of a vice-president being effectively forced from office by the government that installed him, setting a troubling precedent for the independence of constitutional offices. It demonstrates that, in India's parliamentary democracy, even the second-highest constitutional office is not immune to the blunt force of political displeasure. It's also a reminder that even ideologically aligned figures can be dispensable if they become unpredictable. Dhankhar's fall was not about health. It was about power, and who ultimately wields it. He misjudged the tolerance of a prime minister whose style leaves little room for internal dissent.

For the Opposition, Dhankhar's fate offers both vindication and concern. The man they once sought to impeach for excessive partisanship ultimately fell for displaying independence, a paradox that underscores the complexity of institutional politics in contemporary India.

The vacancy now creates immediate political opportunities. With the Bihar election looming, speculation has already begun about using the vice-presidency to accommodate alliance partners or balance caste equations. The constitutional office thus becomes another chip in the great game of coalition management. ■